

Gun violence in Omaha

OPS student affected by gun violence

Daisy Chinchilla Ramos
Reporter

Homicides involving teenagers, especially ones involving guns, have been increasing in recent years in the Omaha area.

The homicide rate in the Omaha area has increased from 29 incidents and 30 victims in 2016 to 32 victims and 29 incidents in 2021, according to the Omaha Police Department. Although the rate of homicide did decrease from 2020 to 2021, it is still higher than it's been in years.

The national average of homicides involving teenagers/young adults has also been increasing. According to the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime, in 2015, the number of homicide victims was up to 1,206 for girls ages 15-24, and 6,074 for boys that same age per 100,000 people in the US.

A junior* at the school that has experience with gun violence has been left with traumatic memories

of an event in which their friend was killed.

"I couldn't do anything for them but be with them and hold their hand while they were crying in pain," the junior said. "It was scary, a scary moment that I never want to experience ever again."

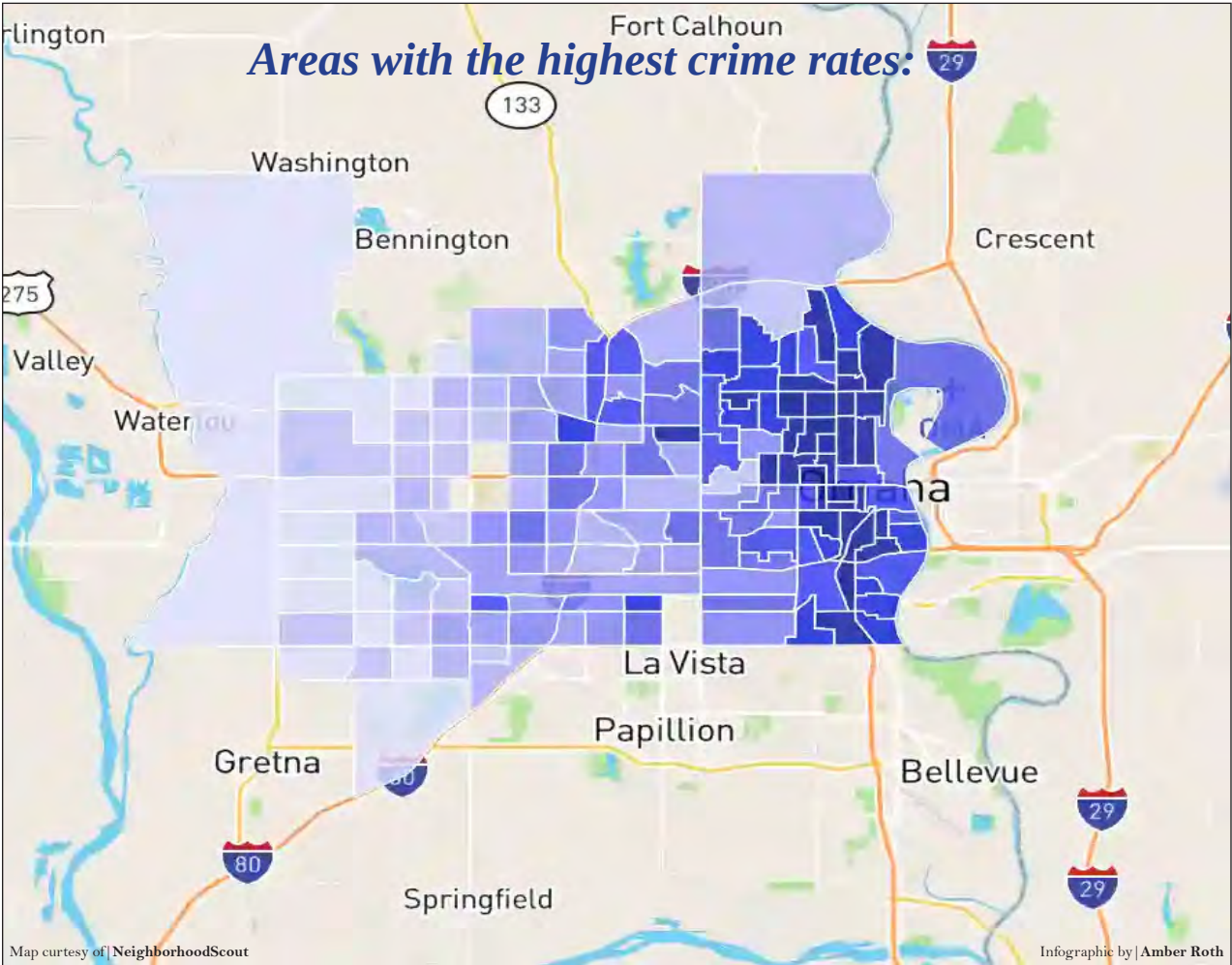
The junior keeps in touch with the friend's parents and visits them when they have the opportunity to, because they feel like they owe it to them and they want to make peace with what happened.

"It's tough to deal with, because I can't get it out of my head, I can't stop it," the junior said.

The junior believes that what happened has matured them and they plan on staying inside more for their safety. They plan on staying out of trouble and keeping their circle of friends small.

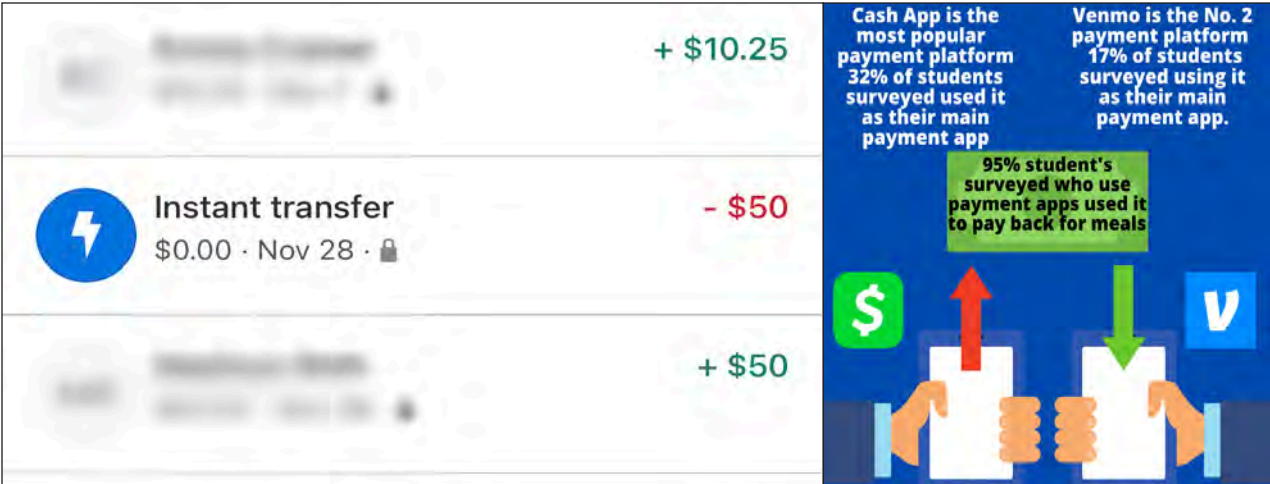
"All it takes is bad timing, don't take your life for granted," the junior said.

*Due to the ongoing investigation, student names for this article were not permitted to be used.



Crime Rates in Omaha			
Non-Fatal Shootings		Homicides	
2016	2021	2016	2021
Incidents: 97	Incidents: 104	Incidents: 29	Incidents: 29
Victims: 110	Victims: 131	Victims: 30	Victims: 32

Will you have to pay taxes?



Payment transfer services to start taxing \$600 or more transactions this year

Justin Diep
Co-Editor in Chief

Starting this year, business users of payment platforms such as Cash App, PayPal and Venmo and will now be required to report income to the IRS if they made \$600 or more.

These platforms will send the user a forum 1099-K and will send the IRS a copy so they can cross reference the one taxpayers file with the one the

payment platform files.

"The IRS requires TPSOs (Third Party Settlement Organizations), such as PayPal and Venmo, to issue a Form 1099-K, which shows the total amount of payments received from a TPSO in the calendar year," PayPal said in a press release.

This law will only apply to business accounts on these payment platforms. Personal use such as paying rent or paying back a

friend for dinner doesn't need to be reported to the IRS.

Zelle is exempt from this reporting because they do not directly handle funds like how Cash App, PayPal or Venmo do.

"If payments you receive on the Zelle Network are taxable, it is your responsibility to report them to the IRS," Zelle's website said.

Before this change to the tax code under the

American Rescue Plan, the COVID response bill passed last March, these platforms only reported earning to the IRS if the user had over 200 transactions and a gross total greater than \$20,000. Taxes filed for 2021 will follow this guideline while earning starting Jan. 1 of this year will be subject to the new law. Users are encouraged to check with the platform they use for details on how to file.

Water damage under floor causes main gym to temporarily close

Justin Diep
Co-Editor in Chief

The main gym is temporarily closed due to standing water found underneath the floor. Buckling and warping of the floor caused safety concerns, canceling the freshman wrestling tournament last Friday and moving the home basketball game today to Bryan Middle.

The total damage is unknown at this point. District officials are inspecting the main gym to determine the damage done to the floor and the next course of action needed to be done to allow the gym to be used again.

"I'm hopeful by the end of this week or the start of next week we'll have a better idea of what the situation is and what we can do moving forward," athletic director Ryan Murtaugh said.

For now, only the south part of the gym will be used for PE classes.

Basketball practice and other PE classes have been moved to the auxiliary gym temporarily while the situation is assessed. Other venues are being explored for future home games such as opponent school's gyms or even moving games to the middle school. Practices may move to nearby elementary schools.

"We are planning for the worst-case scenario, which is we can't use the gym, we're making plan A and plan B, if that does come to light," Murtaugh said.

Potential issues may arise from repairing or total replacement of the gym floor. Ongoing labor and product shortages could lengthen the time needed to fix the floor.

"There's not only issue of cost, but there's also the issue of having product, right now if you look at the country, there's a shortage of wood," Murtaugh said. "We just don't know."